

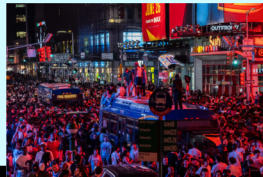
News Weekly

Knicks' long-awaited title sparks wild celebrations — and a night of chaos in New York

The New York Knicks ended their 53-year wait for a third NBA championship, igniting jubilant celebrations across the city. The Knicks secured the title by defeating the San Antonio Spurs 4-1 in the series, claiming victory at Frost Bank Center in San Antonio. Despite the distance, New York City erupted with excitement after the final buzzer. Fans flooded the streets, with celebrities joining the festivities and city leaders planning a ticker-tape parade.

In Times Square, Knicks fans climbed buses, cheered, and chanted. However, the celebrations turned chaotic as some fans clashed with police, smashed windshields, and set off fireworks. The New York City Police Department reported 63 arrests and injuries to 10 officers. A 17-year-old was shot and hospitalized, with three suspects in custody. Gunshots were later fired near 42nd Street and Broadway, although no injuries were reported.

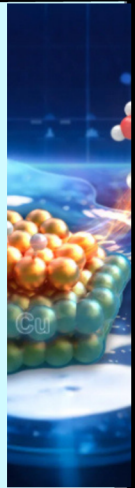
In San Antonio, people like Spike Lee and Timothée Chalamet celebrated with the team, with Chalamet expressing his joy over the Knicks' victory. (Source: NBC)



Scientists crack a decades-old CO2 problem and triple fuel production

In a "Chem" study, Professors Jian Sun and Jiafeng Yu from DICP introduced a novel catalyst design to improve methanol production from CO2. Their approach uses a strong metal-support interaction (SMSI) to create an overlayer structure that separates active sites, enhancing efficiency. The catalyst achieved a space-time yield of 1.2 g-g⁻¹cat⁻¹h⁻¹ at 300 °C and 3 MPa, three times better than traditional Cu/Zn/Al catalysts.

The catalyst promotes CO2 adsorption on zirconia (ZrO2) sites, steering the reaction towards methanol via the formate pathway, unlike conventional methods that begin with C=O bond cleavage. This new strategy reduces carbon monoxide byproducts while maintaining efficient H2 dissociation. Prof. Sun noted that this approach addresses the trade-off between activity and selectivity in CO2 methanol synthesis. (Source: Science Daily)



Late Amad strike seals Ivory Coast win over Ecuador

Substitute Amad Diallo scored a decisive 90th-minute goal, securing a 1-0 victory for Ivory Coast over Ecuador in their FIFA World Cup Group E opener on Sunday. The winning moment unfolded when Wilfried Singo dashed down the right and passed to Manchester United's Diallo, who expertly guided the ball into the far corner from the box's edge.

The lively match saw several first-half chances thwarted by the woodwork. Ecuador's John Yeboah and Alan Minda both hit the crossbar with powerful attempts. Ivory Coast's 19-year-old winger Yan Diomande impressed, narrowly missing the target and later setting up Elye Wahi, whose shot also struck the bar.

The defeat ended Ecuador's 19-game unbeaten run. Ivory Coast manager Emerece Fac praised his team's resilience, highlighting their World Cup ambitions. (Source: Reuters)



California couple fights off 70-pound black bear with hatchet and water bottle outside their home

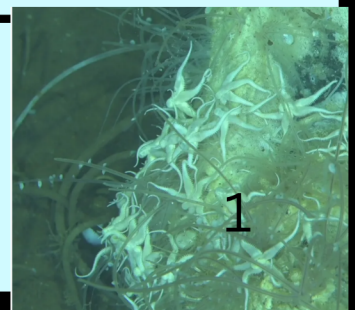
In a wild twist straight out of a nature documentary, a California couple found themselves in a real-life showdown with a 70-pound black bear right outside their Mammoth Lakes home. Their dog had taken on the bear, and while trying to separate the furry fighters, the woman got some unwanted bear hugs and bites. Her partner swiftly turned into an action hero, wielding a hatchet to fend off the bear, scoring a hit. Both humans were whisked away to the hospital with befitting battle scars but are on the mend. The brave dog also walked away with some minor scratches but will be just fine. The California Department of Fish and Wildlife decided the bear was too much of a daredevil for the neighborhood and euthanized it, noting that such bear bravado is rare in those parts. (Source: Fox)



A submersible ride revealed a vast whale graveyard. And it holds more than just bones

Scientists recently explored a remote site in the southeastern Indian Ocean, uncovering one of the largest and deepest whale graveyards. This site, stretching about 746 miles, contains hundreds of fossils, including a previously unknown species. Despite its name, not everything in this graveyard is lifeless. Thousands of feet below the surface, whale remains have been accumulating for at least 5 million years, as evidenced by the fossils. Most remains belong to beaked whales, known for their dolphin-like snouts and deep-diving behavior. These elusive creatures are rarely observed, leaving much about their habits unknown.

Researchers noted some recently deceased whale cadavers still hosting scavengers, called whale falls. These carcasses support diverse deep-sea life forms, such as bone-eating worms, snails, brittle stars, and bivalves that thrive through chemosynthesis. Many of these species might be new to science. An Antarctic minke whale carcass on the seafloor of the Diamantina Zone hosts 26 invertebrate species, including brittle stars and tiny amphipods. Olivier Lambert, a vertebrate paleontologist, highlighted that this discovery shows beaked whale carcasses can play a vital role in deep oceanic ecosystems, akin to larger cetaceans. Despite the graveyard's age, he finds the discovery spectacular. (CNN)



Atom jokes

Why can't you trust atoms?

Because they make up everything.

Elemingle



Sweet Potato Casserole

- Ingredients for the Sweet Potatoes:
 - 3 pounds sweet potatoes, peeled and cubed;
 - ¼ cup packed light brown sugar;
 - ¼ cup unsalted butter, cubed; ¼ cup whole milk; 2 large eggs; 1¼ teaspoon salt;
 - 1 teaspoon vanilla extract.
- For the Topping:
 - 1 cup packed light brown sugar;
 - ¼ cup all-purpose flour;
 - 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon;
 - ¼ cup unsalted butter, melted and cooled;
 - 1 cup pecan halves, chopped.
- **Instructions**
- **For the Sweet Potatoes:**
 - Preheat oven to 375°F. Grease a 9×13-inch dish.
 - Boil sweet potatoes in water, cook until tender, and drain.
 - Mash potatoes, add sugar, butter, milk, eggs, salt, vanilla; mix well.
 - Spread mixture in dish, let cool.
- **For the Topping:**
 - Mix brown sugar, flour, cinnamon. Add butter and pecans.
 - Sprinkle topping over potatoes.
- Bake 25–30 minutes until golden brown. Rest 10 minutes before serving.



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